USER MANUAL · REV 1.0

KLON

Quad-Preset MIDI Drive · a faithful clone of the Klon-style overdrive · handmade in Austria by Walter Craffonara

NOTE This pedal is a faithful, circuit-for-circuit clone of the Klon-style “transparent” overdrive, expanded with functions I added: a relay-switched quad-preset system and MIDI. The names “Klon” and “Centaur” are used only to identify the original circuit this build recreates. CRAFFONARA FX is an independent builder and is not affiliated with, authorised by or endorsed by Klon.

1 Overview & Concept

At its core this is a faithful clone of the Klon-style “transparent” overdrive — the original circuit, with the clipping section switchable between germanium diodes and LEDs.

What I added is the part the original never had: the Gain and Treble controls exist twice. A relay silently switches between the two pots of each channel — by soft-touch button on the pedal, or remotely via MIDI. Dial in a rhythm sound and a solo sound and recall both hands-free.

2 Controls & Connections

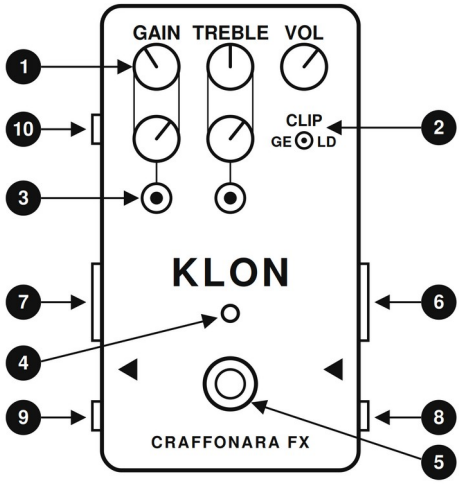


Fig. 1 — Panel and connections

1 GAIN · TREBLE · VOL the main controls for drive, tone colour and output level. GAIN and TREBLE each exist twice: an upper pot with a white marker and a lower pot with a red marker.

2 CLIP toggle GE = stock germanium diodes for the classic voicing, LD = LED clipping for a more dynamic, aggressive drive up to distortion.

3 PRESET buttons one soft-touch button per channel (GAIN, TREBLE), each driving its own relay. LED ring dark = preset #1 (upper pot, white marker); LED ring lit = preset #2 (lower pot, red marker).

4 STATUS LED shows whether the effect is engaged or bypassed. It does NOT indicate which preset is active — that is shown by the LED ring around each PRESET button.

5 FOOTSWITCH silent soft-touch switch, engages / bypasses the effect (relay true bypass).

6 INPUT 6.35 mm mono jack from your guitar or the previous pedal.

7 OUTPUT 6.35 mm mono jack to your amp or the next pedal.

8 MIDI IN TRS socket for incoming MIDI (Type A).

9 MIDI THRU TRS socket passing incoming MIDI on to the next device.

10 POWER 9 V DC, center-negative. Do NOT run this pedal at 18 V.

3 The Quad-Preset System

Gain and Treble each exist twice on the panel: an upper pot with a white marker and a lower pot with a red marker. Each channel has its own PRESET button (4), and each button drives its own relay — the two relays work completely independently of one another.

The LED ring around a PRESET button shows which pot that channel is using:

LED ring dark (preset #1) the upper pot with the white marker is active; the lower pot is muted.

LED ring lit (preset #2) the lower pot with the red marker is active; the upper pot is muted.

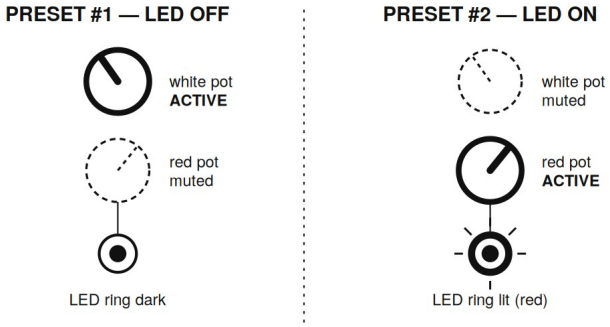


Fig. 2 — Preset states of one channel (Gain or Treble)

Because the two relays switch independently, the two channels give you 2 × 2 = four complete settings in one pedal — a quad-preset system. Recall any of the four by PRESET button or over MIDI: for example a rhythm sound, a lead sound, and two in-between voicings.

> **NOTE** Preset switching is relay-based and click-free. Only the selected pot sits in the signal path, so the muted pot causes no tone loss.

4 MIDI Reference

The pedal responds to MIDI Control Change (CC) messages on its MIDI channel (see the next section).

CC	Value	Command
00	00	TREBLE preset #1 and GAIN preset #1
	01	TREBLE preset #2 and GAIN preset #1
	02	TREBLE preset #1 and GAIN preset #2
	03	TREBLE preset #2 and GAIN preset #2
10	00	TREBLE preset #1
	01	TREBLE preset #2
	02	Toggle TREBLE preset #1 / #2
20	00	STATE: OFF — effect bypassed
	01	STATE: ON — effect engaged
30	00	GAIN preset #1
	01	GAIN preset #2
	02	Toggle GAIN preset #1 / #2

5 Setting the MIDI Channel

1. Disconnect the pedal from the power supply.
2. Press and hold the FOOTSWITCH while connecting the power supply — the STATUS LED lights up and starts to flash, showing the pedal is in channel-set mode.
3. Press the FOOTSWITCH as many times as the channel number you want to set (e.g. three times for MIDI channel 3). The STATUS LED flashes back with each press.
4. Press and hold the FOOTSWITCH until the STATUS LED goes dark and the pedal switches off completely.
5. On the next power-up the pedal responds to the new MIDI channel.

6 Power

This pedal is built for 9 V DC, center-negative, only. Never connect an 18 V supply — the Klon-style circuit generates its own internal rails and 18 V will damage it. There is no battery compartment; power it from a regulated pedalboard supply.

NOTE Power warning: 9 V DC only. Never connect an 18 V supply.

7 Specifications

Parameter	Value
Type	Overdrive — faithful clone of the Klon-style circuit, with a quad-preset system and MIDI
Controls	GAIN ×2, TREBLE ×2 (relay-switched presets), VOL, CLIP toggle
Clipping	GE = germanium diodes, LD = LED clipping
Presets	2 × Gain, 2 × Treble — relay-switched, four combinations
Bypass	Relay true bypass, silent soft-touch footswitch
MIDI	IN + THRU (TRS, Type A), Control Change
Audio I/O	6.35 mm mono input and output
Power	9 V DC, center-negative — do NOT use 18 V
Enclosure	Brushed aluminium, CNC-drilled (Hammond 1590B format)

NOTE Trademark notice: “Klon” and “Centaur” are trademarks of their respective owners. They are used here purely to describe the original circuit that this independent build recreates. CRAFFONARA FX is not affiliated with, authorised by or endorsed by Klon.